

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI): Asia Financial Corporate Day Takeaways: focus on margin

Asia Financial Services

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We hosted OCBC at our Asia Financial Corporate Day on June 13th, 2025. The focus at the meeting was on margin, as OCBC saw an 11bps qoq decline in NIM in 1Q25, much larger than 0-3bps of peers. OCBC noted the recent higher-than-historical pass-through of Fed rate cut into SORA and HIBOR, especially in May, will exert more pressure on asset yields, but partly mitigated by proactive deposit management, as the impact from the TD rate cut should materialize in the coming months. Besides margin, OCBC also reiterated asset quality is under control and provision coverage is sufficient.

Key Takeaways

- **Active deposit management should help to mitigate NIM pressure.** OCBC noted that the recent pass-through of the Fed rate cut into SORA and HIBOR, especially in May, has been higher than the historical level of 50%-60% and 100% respectively, due to flush liquidity in the system. This higher than expected pass-through exerted downward pressure on asset yields. That said, OCBC has proactively managed its deposit base by lowering TD rates and reducing rates on OCBC 360 accounts from early May. The benefits from CoF will materialize in the coming months, offsetting some of the yield compression. Furthermore, OCBC noted it has completed a strategic allocation into investment securities in 1Q25, and deposit growth will align more closely with loan growth for the remainder of the year, which should provide additional support in managing funding costs. OCBC will provide an update on NIM guidance at 1H25 results, previous guidance is around 2%, baking in 3 Fed rate cut and historical pass-through level assumptions. We forecast 2025E NIM of 2.01%.
- **Asset quality is under control and provision coverage is sufficient.** On HK CRE risk, OCBC distinguished between large corporate, which are not a worry, and the mid-tier borrowers (mainly legacy from Wing Hang Bank), which are

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- **Wealth remains a growth driver.** OCBC noted that investment sentiment was negatively impacted by the tariff announcement, however, wealth inflow was resilient and AUM continue to see inflows. In addition, the on-boarding of new RMs in key wealth hubs is expected to contribute to future AUM growth.
- **Remains committed to S\$2.5bn capital return plan.** OCBC announced conditional exit offer for GEH on Jun 6th. The bank estimated the final offer to have 0.4ppt impact on CET1 on pro-forma basis, assuming 100% acquisition. Despite the offer, OCBC remained committed to the S\$2.5bn capital return plan.

We are Buy rated on OCBC with a 12-month target price of S\$19.7 (based on a two-stage DDM). Key risks include: (-) Sudden or sharper-than-expected Fed cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity.

Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: S\$72.0bn / \$56.3bn 3m ADTV: S\$118.6mn / \$90.1mn Singapore Asean Financials M&A Rank: 3	Net inc. (\$\$ mn)	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	EPS (\$\$)	7,587.0	7,055.8	7,363.2	7,910.8
	EPS growth (%)	1.68	1.57	1.64	1.77
	P/E (X)	8.1	(6.3)	4.4	7.4
	P/B (X)	8.6	10.2	9.8	9.1
	ROA (%)	1.1	1.2	1.2	1.1
	ROE (%)	1.3	1.1	1.1	1.1
	Price/PPOP (X)	13.7	12.1	12.2	12.4
	Dividend yield (%)	8.2	8.7	8.4	7.9
		7.0	5.9	6.2	6.6
		3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
	EPS (\$\$)	0.42	0.40	0.39	0.35

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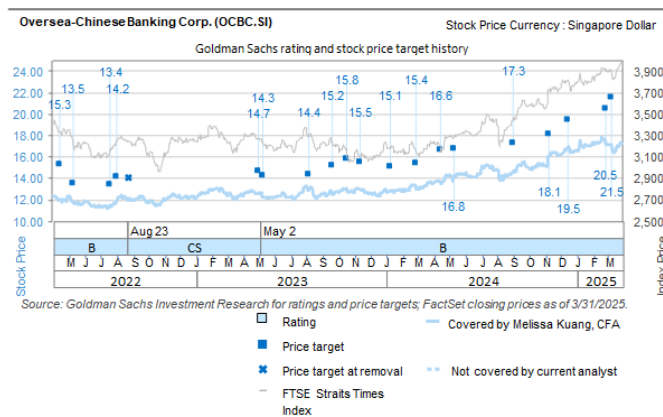
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